



The La Coupole section on the ground floor showcases bags and accessories from global brands, while the fourth floor sports edgy labels; The grand façade of Galeries Lafayette in Kalaghoda (Below)



tionship is a testament to what great partnerships can build. We are a French brand imbued in Indian culture, at Galeries Lafayette Mumbai and are proud to host and exchange culturally with delegates from all over the world. The upswings will play out over time.

Q: Galeries Lafayette is a family-owned brand that has entered in a partnership with another family-owned brand in the Aditya Birla Group. Does that position Galeries Lafayette India at an advantage?
Absolutely. Both families are fifth generation entrepreneurs. There is tremendous history on both sides, with economic and sociological contributions.

Q: How is the French brand ensconcing itself in a microcosm of Indian culture?
We are creating the eco-system of 'warm luxury'. With over 250 brands houses under the roof, 85 per cent are international brands and 15 per cent Indian.

There are intrinsic elements in décor and the brand bouquet. Lotus-motif parchin kari inlay on the atrium floor, the Cupola at the entrance —inspired by l'Intrépide (the French observation balloon of 1796), the skilfully shaped surreal archway by visual artist Sheehij Kaul, the Escalator Wall, envisioned by artist Reshidev RK as Windows to Paris, installations by origami artist Ankon Mitra in the atrium come together as a composite expression of French and Indian flair.

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Sathyajit R., CEO International Brands, Aditya Birla Fashion Retail Limited

Q: The iconic gourmet gospels are missing, yet.
The rooftop plays a pivotal role at all Galeries Lafayette locations worldwide. We are landscaping the colossal roof top - with its panoramic views of the heritage district of Mumbai, and have set up Julien, a design-led patisserie and dessert house by Aditya Birla New Age Hospitality, the hospitality arm of the Aditya Birla Group, on the first floor at Galeries Lafayette.

Q: What does the 2026 calendar summon?
One concise event every month, followed by a grand scale event every quarter, to engage our guests culturally. Culture has always played a vital role in the building of 'soft power'. There are music performances and in-store gigs lined up.

Q: What distinguishes Galeries in the luxury landscape of India?
We have repurposed heritage precincts in a modern format. The exterior is over 100 years old. There is democracy of brands across beauty, accessories, clothes in the umbrella of labels under the Galeries Lafayette roof. The service is impeccable with multilingual team on the floor, and hands-free shopping experiences with deliveries at home.

Q: What has been your biggest learning?
Perseverance. Fashion is a very dynamic business. What works one season, ebbs the other season. Intuitive luxury formats using digital tools are the way ahead.

Q: What's next?
An omni channel app experience with in-store navigator and a loyalty club format. We intend to move slowly and steadily. India is a challenging country for Western brands to take root, owing to the diversity across different markets and first world rentals. We intend to intensify story-telling through the period of incubation across three to five years, and bring in world-class craftsmanship to Delhi, Bangalore and Hyderabad next.